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ECONOMIC SURVEYS BY THE OECD

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WESTERN EUROPEAN UNION

IRELAND

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MARCH 1964

ORGANISATION FOR ECONOMIC
CO-OPERATION AND DEVELOPMENT

PARIS

IRELAND

BASIC STATISTICS

THE LAND

Area (thousand sq. km.)	70
Agricultural area (av. 1956-57/1959-60) as % of total area	68

Population of major cities, with suburbs, 1961 Census :

Dublin	593,000
Cork	116,000
Dun Laoghaire	68,000
Limerick	51,000

THE PEOPLE

Population (mid-1962)	2,824,000
Number of inhabitants per sq. km.	40
Decrease in population:	
Annual average 1960-62	5,000
Natural increase in population:	
Annual average 1960-62	27,000
Emigration:	
Annual average 1960-62	33,000
Annual average per thousand of population	12
Labour force, total at work, April 1962	1,049,000
Employment in:	
—Agriculture, forestry and fishing	368,000
—Industry and construction	265,000
—Other sectors	416,000

PRODUCTION

Gross national product in 1962 (£ million)	761
GNP per head (U.S.dollars) (1962)	755
Gross fixed investment (1962):	
—as % of GNP	16
—per head (U.S.dollars)	118
Origin of gross domestic product in 1962:	
—Agriculture	23
—Industry and construction	32
—Services	45

THE GOVERNMENT

Public current expenditure on goods and services, 1962 (as % of GNP)	12
General government current revenue, 1962 (as % of GNP)	25
Public debt, 31st March 1963 (as % of central government current revenue)	289
Composition of Parliament (Jan. 1964):	
Fianna Fail	71 seats
Fine Gael	47 seats
Labour	18 seats
Others	8 seats

Last elections: October 1961.

LIVING STANDARDS

Food consumption, calories per head per day (1962)	3,428
Average weekly earnings of industrial workers in September 1963 (in shillings)	186.6
Public current expenditure on education per head, in U.S. dollars (1961-62)	18
No. of passenger cars in use per thousand of population (1962)	73
No. of telephones per thousand of population (1962)	61
No. of radio sets per thousand of population (1962)	148

FOREIGN TRADE

Exports:

Exports of goods and services as % of GNP, 1962	37
Main exports, 1962 (% of total domestic exports):	
Live cattle	21
Beef and veal	9
Textile manufactures	4
Clothing	4
Beer	4
Bacon	4
Main customers, 1962 (% of total):	
United Kingdom	73
United States	8
European Economic Community	6

Imports:

Imports of goods and services as % of GNP, 1962	40
Main imports 1962 (% of total):	
Machinery and electrical goods	16
Vehicles	8
Chemicals, including fertilisers	8
Textile manufactures	7
Petroleum	4
Main suppliers, 1962 (% of total):	
United Kingdom	50
European Economic Community	16
United States	8

THE CURRENCY

Monetary unit: Irish pound.

Currency unit per U.S.dollar: 0,357

ECONOMIC SURVEYS BY THE OECD

IRELAND

ORGANISATION FOR ECONOMIC CO-OPERATION AND DEVELOPMENT

The Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development was set up under a Convention signed in Paris on 14th December 1960 by the Member countries of the Organisation for European Economic Co-operation and by Canada and the United States. This Convention provides that the O.E.C.D. shall promote policies designed:

- *to achieve the highest sustainable economic growth and employment and a rising standard of living in Member countries, while maintaining financial stability, and thus to contribute to the development of the world economy;*
- *to contribute to sound economic expansion in Member as well as non-member countries in the process of economic development;*
- *to contribute to the expansion of world trade on a multilateral, non-discriminatory basis in accordance with international obligations.*

The legal personality possessed by the Organisation for European Economic Co-operation continues in the O.E.C.D., which came into being on 30th September 1961.

The Members of O.E.C.D. are: Austria, Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, the Federal Republic of Germany, Greece, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Turkey, the United Kingdom and the United States.

This document was approved
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in March 1964.

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IRELAND

1. 1964 marks the transition from the first Programme for Economic Expansion (1959-63) to the second (1964-70). The five years of the first programme witnessed Ireland's period of fastest economic growth in the century. Although certain special factors —buoyant demand for exports and an important margin of unused industrial capacity—were operating during the early part of the period, chief credit for this result belongs to the programme itself. Not the least of its achievements was to convince public opinion in Ireland that more rapid economic growth was feasible. At the present time the gross national product is growing at over 4 per cent a year, and notably faster than the rate achieved in the 1950s. The basis for a further advance, over the period covered by the second programme, has been laid.

2. Part I of this survey examines the results of the first programme and current trends in the economy. Part II discusses the second programme and Part III considers the main conditions for its implementation.

I. THE FIRST PROGRAMME FOR ECONOMIC EXPANSION (1959-1963)

a) Main Features of the Programme

3. In the years immediately preceding the introduction of the programme, the economy was still affected by the restrictive measures adopted in 1955 to correct a balance of payments deficit; between 1955 and 1958, the gross national product declined in real terms. This experience, together with the previous record of slow growth, no doubt influenced the cautious forecast in the programme that the growth rate might be raised from 1 to 2 per cent a year; in fact the rate achieved averaged over 4 per cent a year (see Table 1).

4. The first programme sought to release "a dynamic of progress", and its success in this respect is the most striking feature of the many changes which have come over the Irish economy since 1959. The transformation of attitudes towards economic growth is remarkable; whereas, in 1959, there were many who considered a 2 per cent growth

rate too ambitious, it would be difficult today to persuade opinion that the growth target envisaged for the second programme should be lower than that actually achieved in the past five years.

5. Three aspects of the programme were of particular importance: the stress given to productive investment, the efforts made to modernise the economy, and the encouragement given to exports.

TABLE 1. SUPPLY AND USE OF RESOURCES

Average annual percentage changes in volume.

	1952-55	1955-58	1ST PROGRAMME 1958-63	2ND PROGRAMME 1963-70
GNP (market prices)	+2.0	— 1.0	+ 4.4	+4.3
of which:				
Industry	+4.9	— 1.9	+ 7.4	+7.0
Agriculture	+0.4	— 2.1	+ 3.3	+3.2
Private consumption	+3.2	— 0.8	+ 3.8	+3.5
Public consumption	+2.9	— 0.9	+ 3.6	+6.3
Total gross investment	+9.2	—13.9	+12.9	+4.8
of which:				
Total fixed capital formation	+4.1	— 8.1	+ 9.4	+5.6
Exports of goods and services	+0.1	+ 2.5	+ 6.7	+5.9
Imports of goods and services	+6.3	— 2.9	+ 8.1	+5.0

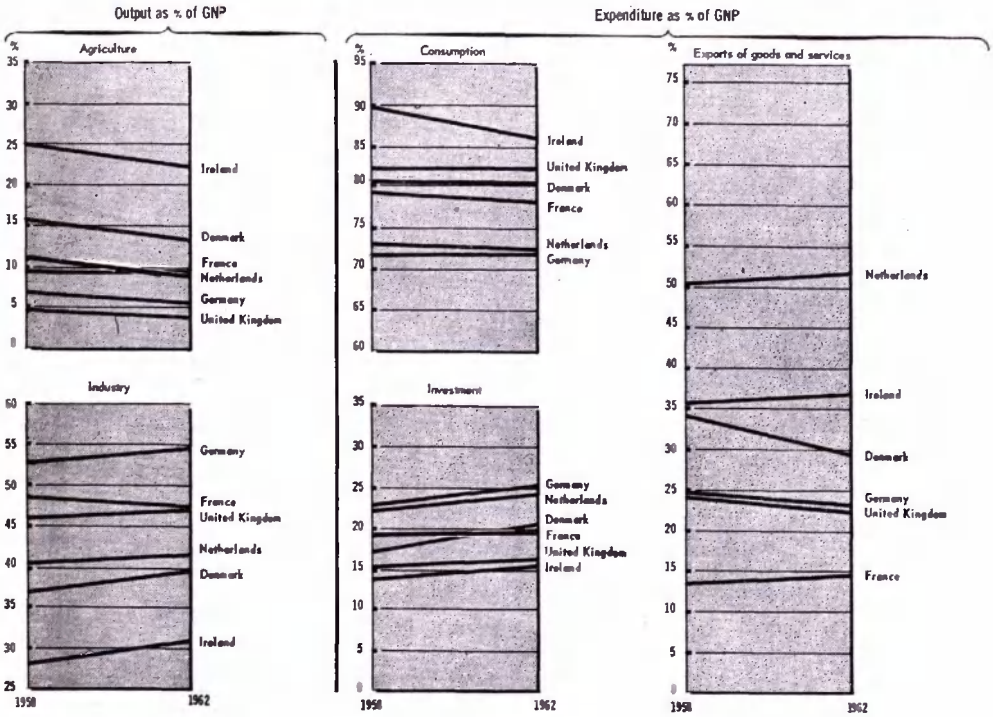
Source: Irish submission to O.E.C.D. and Second Programme for Economic Expansion and Secretariat estimates.

6. The rate of investment[1], although still low compared to other O.E.C.D. countries, has risen appreciably in recent years—from less than 14 per cent in 1958 to nearly 17 per cent in 1963. A major stimulus was the sharp increase in public capital expenditure, which almost doubled in current prices between fiscal 1957/58 and 1963/64, with a re-allocation in favour of productive investment. Social investment has also risen, but its share in total public investment has fallen from about two-fifths in 1957 to one-quarter today. The sectors where the biggest increases in public investment have taken place are fuel and power, agriculture, and industry.

7. Private investment has also risen sharply, influenced by more buoyant demand expectations and policy incentives. Both industry and agriculture now benefit from an extensive range of grants, subsidies and credits as the State has come to play an important role in channelling savings to the private sector. A new element of

1. Gross fixed asset formation as per cent of the gross national product, at current prices, O.E.C.D. definitions.

Diagram 1. STRUCTURE OF NATIONAL PRODUCT IN IRELAND AND OTHER WESTERN EUROPEAN COUNTRIES



Source: Submissions to O.E.C.D.

considerable importance for the future has been the growth of direct investment in Ireland by foreign firms.

8. The modernisation of the economy has been pursued in both the public and private sectors. In fuel and power, transport and communications which are controlled by public bodies, programmes have been designed to increase both capacity and efficiency. Private industry has benefited from the setting-up of new firms using modern techniques, notably in the chemicals and electrical branches. Many of these firms have been financed partly or wholly by foreign capital. In agriculture, the condition of the cattle herds—Ireland's largest single export product—has been improved by a vigorous campaign, now nearing completion, to eradicate bovine tuberculosis. Agricultural advisory services have been extended, and increased use of fertilizers and lime encouraged.

9. Exports began to rise sharply after 1958, with a particularly fast increase in industrial exports; agricultural sales abroad have also

risen, though rather unevenly. Increased attention has been paid to sales promotion for Irish products abroad, particularly agricultural products. Vigorous sales campaigns have been undertaken, notably in Britain, for Irish bacon and butter, and the Irish Sugar Company has taken the initiative in setting up plants for processing food products for export. Exports of industrial products were stimulated by the tax exemption, introduced in 1956 and extended in 1958, for profits earned from exports, and by the prospect of increased competition on the home market as import policy became increasingly liberal. More recently, new firms with foreign participation, whose output is almost entirely sold abroad, have begun to influence the figures for exports of manufactured goods.

10. The marked change in trends of output and demand after the introduction of the first expansion programme has had a significant impact upon employment and emigration. Employment in manufacturing rose between 1951 and 1955 but declined again subsequently and, in 1958, was no higher than it had been in 1951. From 1958 onwards the rate of increase has been about 2 per cent annually. As employment in other non-agricultural sectors also rose, emigration was cut by one-half from about 40,000 in 1955 to less than 20,000 in 1963, and there was a decline in unemployment despite the continued fall in agricultural employment. As a result, the population of Ireland is now increasing, albeit still very slowly.

b) The Current Situation

11. Current trends in the economy confirm that the average pace of advance during the five years of the first programme is being maintained (see Table 2). The volume of GNP rose by at least 4.0 per cent in 1963, rather faster than in 1962.

Table 2. RECENT CHANGES IN OUTPUT AND DEMAND

Annual percentage changes in volume.

	1962	1963 (estimates)
Private consumption	3.5	4.2
Public consumption	6.2	3.7
Fixed investment	10.4	12.6
Exports of goods and services	— 1.8	6.6
Imports of goods and services	4.9	8.3
Gross national product at market prices	3.3	4.0

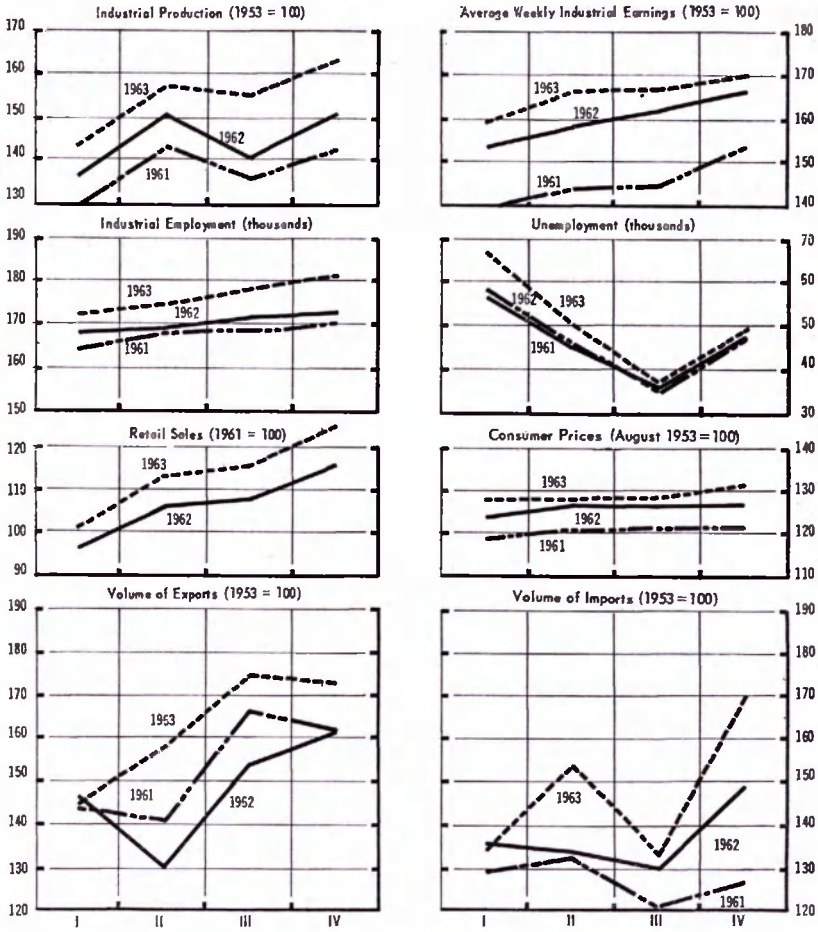
Source: Irish Submission to the O.E.C.D.

In fact the rate of growth in the second half of 1963 and early in 1964 is probably nearer 5 than 4 per cent assuming a normal level of

agricultural output. Manufacturing production, growing by 5 per cent a year during the first half of 1963, has risen at a rate of about 8 per cent since then.

12. The acceleration of the rise in manufacturing production since mid-1963 has been associated with a marked upturn in exports, particularly of machinery and transport equipment. On a year-to-year basis, exports of goods other than live animals, food and food preparations rose by 11 per cent in the first ten months of 1963. More buoyant demand conditions in the United Kingdom have contributed notably to this improvement in export markets. Exports of live cattle to Britain were also high in 1963.

Diagram 2. SHORT-TERM ECONOMIC INDICATORS



Source: Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin.

13. Home demand has also been expanding fast. It is likely that expenditure on both construction and plant and equipment contributed substantially to the rise of 12.6 per cent in the volume of gross fixed asset formation. There was a slower increase in stocks in 1963 than the previous year, mainly because heavy exports of live cattle largely absorbed higher production, so that any rise in cattle stocks is likely to have been slight. Private consumption rose in rough proportion to the GNP, while the increase in public consumption slowed down.

14. Consumer prices were 2 1/2 per cent higher on an average in 1963 than in 1962. Prices rose faster at the end of the year with the imposition of a general turnover tax of 2 1/2 per cent in November on retail sales of goods and services. Prices of the output of industry remained steady, but import prices of food, raw materials and manufactured goods moved slightly upwards. Average hourly earnings in manufacturing rose by 3 per cent between September 1962 and September 1963, about two-thirds of the increase in productivity in industry, so that unit labour costs declined. But they have risen since then.

15. In February, 1963, the Government published a White Paper which drew attention to the fact that, following the wage round at the end of 1961, nominal incomes had risen faster than productivity and suggested that a pause was necessary until productivity had caught up. In fact a further wage round did not begin until the beginning of 1964 when it took the form of a "headline agreement" between the two employer and trade union organisations. This overall agreement was for a maximum rise of 12 per cent, or of 20 shillings for a full-time adult male worker, whichever be the greater. The application of the recommendation has been left to bargaining between the employers and the unions in individual sectors, but it appears to have been respected. The "headline" agreement is to remain in force for a period of two and a half years, during the last six months of which a new agreement is to be negotiated.

16. It is difficult exactly to estimate the impact upon prices of this wage and salary settlement. There will probably be some tendency to pass part of so large and sudden an increase in labour costs on in the form of higher prices. But the rise in prices may be relatively moderate in view of the facts that:

a) productivity rose faster than wages in 1963;

b) although the immediate rise in costs is rather steep, the average rise over the two and a half years covered by the settlement—5 per cent a year—should not be very much in excess of the rise in labour productivity in manufacturing;

c) protective industrial tariffs were reduced by a further 10 per cent on 1st January last, following a similar cut on 1st January 1963, and further cuts are to take place on 1st January, 1965.

TABLE 3. BALANCE OF PAYMENTS

£ million.

	1961	1962	1963	1970 2ND PROGRAMME (1960 PRICES)
Exports	293	294		446
Merchandise	171	165	187	282
Invisibles	122	129		164
Imports	292	307		462
Merchandise	253	266	298	392
Invisibles	39	41		70
Trade balance	— 82	—101	—111	—110
Current balance	+ 1	— 13	— 20	— 16
Net capital receipts	+ 13.6	+ 22	+ 23	n.a.
Change in reserves (— = Increase)	— 14.6	— 9	— 3	n.a.

Source: **Irish Submission to the O.E.C.D. and 2nd Programme.**

17. The balance of payments was fairly satisfactory in 1963. At the end of the year total official foreign exchange reserves and the foreign assets of the commercial banks were £3 million higher at £237 million, than their level of a year earlier (see Table 3). The current deficit rose somewhat; a deterioration of the trade balance was only partly offset by an increase in net invisible receipts. But the deficit on current account was financed by a further inflow of foreign capital; foreign direct investment in industry was again high, and there was probably some foreign purchase of Irish securities. Current account deficits averaging £16 million are expected over the period covered by the Second Programme.

II. THE SECOND PROGRAMME FOR ECONOMIC EXPANSION

18. The second programme covers the seven years 1964 to 1970. This is rather a long period for an operational programme, particularly since the economy is in the midst of a process of rapid structural change. But since the 1960's as a whole have been taken by the United Nations and the O.E.C.D. as a decade of development, the authorities considered it appropriate to look forward as far as 1970. External conditions are assumed to remain relatively favourable, with activity abroad rising in line with the 50 per cent target which the O.E.C.D. countries have set for themselves for the 1960's.

19. The following paragraphs have been based on the preliminary outline of the programme which the authorities published in August,

1963 to provide a basis for discussion with representatives of the private sector. A revised and more detailed programme will be published in 1964.

Production and Employment

20. The programme, summarised in Table 1, is based on an increase in the real gross national product of over 4 per cent a year. This is roughly in line with the rate achieved in the 1959-1963 period, and with the 50 per cent growth target of the O.E.C.D. countries (4.2 per cent a year). With employment expected to rise by less than 1 per cent a year, an average annual rate of growth in output per employed person of nearly 3.5 per cent will be needed to achieve the GNP target.

21. The expansion is likely to be accompanied by considerable structural adjustments towards a pattern in which industry is more and agriculture relatively less important. Agricultural output is expected to continue to grow; but with domestic food consumption rising very slowly, and with protective policies abroad hampering any very considerable increase in exports, the growth—even under improved international marketing arrangements—is not expected to exceed 2.7 per cent a year, consequently below the increase of total output. The service sectors may also expand rather more slowly than GNP. In these circumstances, the programme aims at a strong expansion of industrial production, amounting to some 7 per cent a year.

22. The targets set for output are ambitious, but should not be unattainable. They are roughly in line with the rates of growth achieved under the first programme, and appear to be considered by the private sector as realistic. With relatively favourable external conditions, and a continuation of the vigorous growth policies adopted in recent years, it is difficult to dissent from the growth targets adopted in the programme.

Table 4. CHANGES IN EMPLOYMENT AND PRODUCTIVITY 1960-1970

SECTOR	ANNUAL AVERAGE % INCREASE :		
	OUTPUT	EMPLOYMENT	PRODUCTIVITY
Agriculture, forestry and fishing	2.7	—1.8	4.6
Industry	7.0	+3.0	3.9
Other domestic	3.6	+1.3	2.3
GNP	4.14	+0.7	3.4

Source: Second Programme for Economic Expansion.

23. If the output targets are achieved, overall demand for labour should rise. The aim is to reduce emigration by 1970 to around 10,000 persons a year, about half the present rate; some fall in unemployment from its average level of some 50,000 in 1963 is also looked for. In agriculture, as productivity is expected to rise fast (4.6 per cent a year) but market prospects are realistically estimated to absorb increases of only 2.7 per cent in production, employment will continue to decline. The authorities estimate that nearly 144,000 new jobs will have to be created in non-agricultural activities between 1960 and 1970 and this will not be easy to achieve.

Investment and Consumption

24. The investment required to sustain the rate of growth of output is difficult to estimate. Over the last five years, gross fixed investment rose much faster than GNP with a rise in the investment rate from the low level of 14 per cent to which it had fallen in 1958 to 17 per cent. There was an even faster rise in gross investment as stocks were at a low ebb at the beginning of the period. The data available at present imply that investment is expected to rise less rapidly during the second programme although there will be some further increase in the ratio of investment to GNP, to 18 per cent by 1970 compared with the present level of 17 per cent. This implies that the marginal capital/output ratio[1] will remain very favourable (at about 4). The authorities feel that in many sectors a considerable increase in output can be achieved without much investment expenditure, both because of an expected increase in the rate of capacity utilisation, and because there is considerable scope for raising productivity through the introduction of more efficient production methods. But judging by the rate at which fixed investment has been rising since 1958, it may well tend to rise somewhat faster in the next few years than expected.

25. No breakdown between private and public investment has yet been released. But since considerable emphasis is to be given to the development of educational, research and vocational training facilities, public investment in these items is likely to rise fairly rapidly. A strong increase in current public expenditure is also envisaged, notably in the fields of education, research and health. This is very much in line with the trends in most other O.E.C.D. countries, but the level of public expenditure in relation to GNP is still relatively low in Ireland. It is expected to rise somewhat during the second programme.

26. Private consumption is intended to grow at about the same rate as over the last five years—3.5 per cent a year. The rate will

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1. The relationship between the rate of investment and the rate of growth of GNP.

have to be kept below the increase in GNP if a reasonable balance between supply and demand is to be preserved; room must be left for investment and public consumption to expand faster than GNP.

The Foreign Balance

27. In an economy where foreign trade is a high proportion of GNP—nearly 40 per cent for exports of goods and services—growth prospects are intimately tied to external conditions. This is particularly the case with a population too small to provide modern industries or agriculture with adequate outlets. The projected trends in exports and imports of goods and services from now until 1970 together with comparable data for the past decade are given in Table 5. The estimates are based upon the assumption that Ireland will become a member of the European Economic Community before 1970. Both exports and imports are expected to rise faster than GNP, but the rates of growth are thought likely to be somewhat lower than in the recent past, though considerably greater than in the years before 1959. The programme is based on an increase in industrial exports of 11 per cent a year. Agricultural exports are also expected to rise—a projection highly influenced by the assumption of E.E.C. membership by 1970. Agricultural products account for about two-thirds of total merchandise exports, with live animals the most important item.

28. The import estimate has been based upon the effect upon the main categories of imports of the expected increases in the major items of national expenditure. Consequently, part of the slowing down in the increase in imports may be due to the slowing down of the rise in fixed asset formation, where the import content is relatively high. Again, in 1958, after the period of stagnation of production since 1955, stocks were low and had to be replenished. Consequently, it may be that the rise in imports after 1959 was exceptionally fast for some time. Nevertheless, the slower rise in imports expected in the

Table 5. FOREIGN TRADE

Average annual percentage changes in volume.

	1952-58	1st programme 1958-63	2nd programme 1963-70
Exports: Total goods and services	+1.3	+6.7	+5.9
of which: Merchandise	+3.1	+8.3	+6.2
Imports: Total goods and services	+1.6	+8.1	+5.0
of which: Merchandise	+1.8	+8.9	+4.4

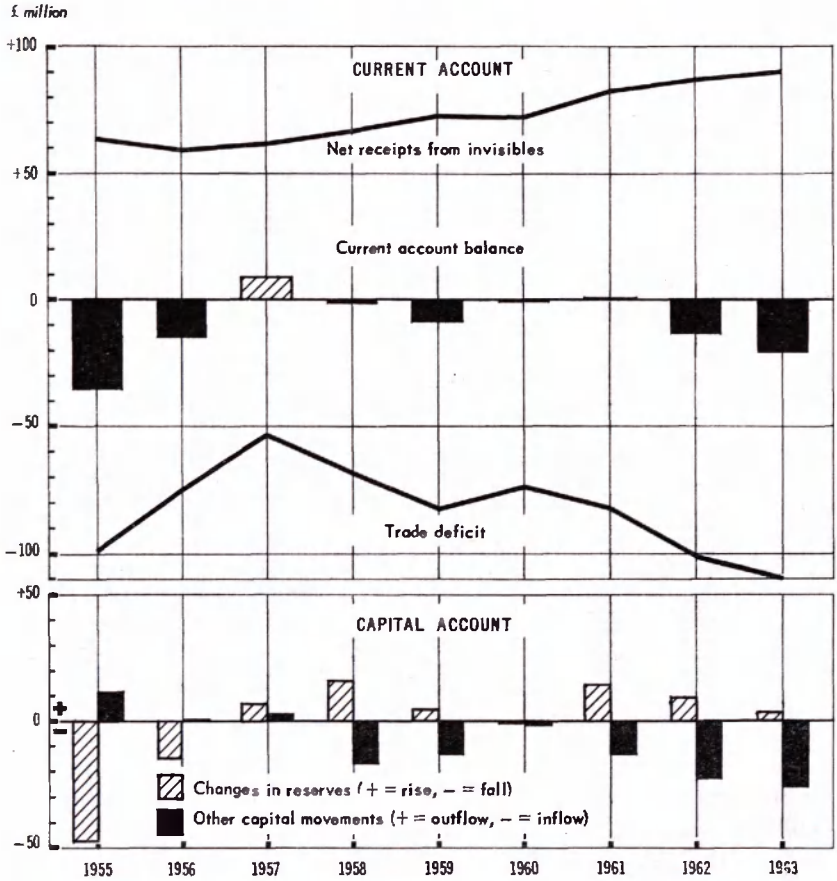
Source: 2nd Programme and Irish Submission to O.E.C.D.

period up to 1970, despite the recent reductions in tariffs and enlargements in quotas and those planned for the future may not in fact materialise. If it does not, a faster rise in exports will be called for.

29. These trends are expected to lead to current account deficits between 1964 and 1970 of £16 million or roughly the same as the average for 1962/63 (see Table 3). The continued receipt of private capital from abroad, and the possibility of having recourse to government borrowing or of using part of Ireland's substantial reserves of gold and foreign exchange, are thought to be sufficient guarantees that a current deficit of this order of magnitude can be financed without difficulty.

30. It would certainly seem reasonable for Ireland to try to accelerate the development of the economy by some import of foreign

Diagram 3. BALANCE OF PAYMENTS 1955-1963



Source: Central Statistics Office.

capital. The investment rate is likely to rise, and the heavy dependence on agricultural exports which are faced with protective policies abroad complicates the problem of maintaining a stable external balance. Foreign capital should not, of course, be a substitute for measures to stimulate domestic savings, nor for proper action to deal with a balance of payments deficit resulting from domestic inflation. But if it is needed to maintain a satisfactory rate of growth in non-inflationary conditions, a moderate inflow of foreign capital would seem appropriate.

31. The estimate of foreign borrowing needs is, of course, uncertain; the forecasts of imports and exports are based on a number of assumptions about conditions external to the Irish economy, some of which may prove to be too optimistic. The maintenance of a current deficit of the order of magnitude envisaged is likely to require considerable efforts to increase exports and to limit the rise in imports under progressively more liberal trading conditions. If, however, imports did show an excessive tendency to outrun exports it might be necessary to curtail internal spending by fiscal or other measures.

III. THE IMPLEMENTATION OF THE ECONOMIC PROGRAMME

32. In external conditions not too different from those assumed in the programme, implementation of the programme will very largely depend on:

a) further rapid structural re-adjustment;
b) the maintenance of economic stability;
c) some improvement of the administrative machinery of the government.

a) Structural Re-adjustment

33. With protective policies abroad preventing the full utilisation of productive capacity in Irish agriculture, rapid economic growth in Ireland depends to a large extent on the maintenance of a high rate of industrial expansion. Greater access to foreign markets for food products would greatly facilitate Ireland's development problem, but it is doubtful whether, under any conditions, agriculture could provide suitable employment openings for the future growth of the population. The objective of increasing the labour force at work in Ireland can only be achieved by creating jobs in non-agricultural pursuits; given the already high proportion of employment in service occupations, the brunt of this burden must borne by industry.

34. The structural re-adjustments needed give rise to a number of problems, both in agriculture and industry. With agricultural

output likely to rise only moderately, an adequate increase in the incomes of the agricultural population requires a strong increase in productivity and a further rapid movement of labour from agriculture to other sectors; in Ireland where a third of the population is still engaged in farming, any solution of the agricultural income problem which implied a further development of the present range of state support schemes would run the risk of imposing an intolerable strain on the budget and of encouraging production of unsaleable surpluses. The Government has an important role to play in promoting agricultural productivity and in facilitating the mobility of labour. The second programme gives considerable emphasis to a further expansion of the agricultural education and advisory services, research programmes, the development of better marketing methods, vocational training, and labour mobility.

35. The rate of growth of industrial output aimed at is considerable, and the programme states that if agricultural growth for any reason falls short of the target, industry will have to step up its expansion further. In this connection it could be a useful exercise to examine alternative growth paths according to different sets of assumptions regarding the key variables. With present trends towards freer international trade in manufactured products, the programme states that the industrial economy faces two main problems: adaptation and development. The active government policies adopted to stimulate industrial development under the first expansion programme will be continued. Generous grants and special loan facilities are available towards the cost of re-equipment and adaptation. The Technical Assistance Scheme has recently been extended in scope and size: grants are now available of up to 50 per cent of the cost of engaging industrial consultants and of sending management and labour on training courses. Industrial research is being encouraged. Efficiency is being promoted by an active use of tariff policy, and the encouragement of foreign direct investment in Ireland will be continued.

36. It is fortunate that the trade unions appear to understand the need for rapid structural adjustments and to be prepared to co-operate in meeting the challenge those adjustments represent. And it is important that the spirit of collaboration which reigns at present between the employers' and workers' organisations should be maintained. For this to be achieved the authorities must have an active manpower policy. In particular, the labour problems involved in the rapid structural changes now taking place will call for great attention in order to facilitate re-adaptation and reduce to a minimum the hardship suffered by those directly affected.

b) Economic Stability

37. The maintenance of economic stability and competitive costs

is essential both for the development of the economy and for the balance of payments. To keep the deficit on the current account of the balance of payments within reasonable limits, excessive rises in costs and prices must be avoided; and success in obtaining the external finance needed to implement the programme will to a large extent depend on the maintenance of economic stability at home. The remarkable expansion of exports over the last few years shows that the competitive position of Irish industry is strong; it is important that it should be maintained.

38. With unemployment and underemployment still relatively high, general excess demand conditions would seem unlikely to appear in the near future. But bottlenecks may easily arise in individual sectors well before full employment has been reached, and it is an important objective of the programme to keep the increase in private consumption below the rise in output. Demand management policy will therefore have an important role to play in the implementation of the programme; an improvement in two directions would seem particularly desirable.

39. First, there is need for a more flexible use of the government budget as an instrument of demand management policy. Monetary policy is still evolving in Ireland, but even if more refined instruments are developed, the scope for an independent monetary policy will be limited because of the close monetary integration with the United Kingdom. In these conditions further efforts must be made to develop an active and flexible fiscal policy.

40. Second, there is need for a more active incomes policy to ensure that the rise in nominal incomes is kept in line with the advance in productivity. This is not an easy task for government policy, but experience suggests that it is essential that progress should be made towards the development of policies exerting a more direct impact on the movement of income than the traditional monetary and fiscal measures. The Government has an important role to play in this connection by evolving adequate machinery for wage and income determination. But its efforts will only succeed if labour and management show co-operation and responsibility.

c) Administrative Problems

41. There are two sets of problems:

- *a)* those related to co-operation between the authorities and the private sector;
- *b)* those related to the government machine concerned with the implementation of the programme.

42. To strengthen co-operation between the authorities and the private sector, the National Industrial Economic Council (N.I.E.C.)

was set up in the autumn of 1963. There are 29 members; eight, together with the Chairman, are appointed by the Government; eight represent employers and industrialists, two come from State Boards and ten from the trade unions. The Departments of Finance and Industry and Commerce provide the Secretariat for the Council. The role of the N.I.E.C. is "to prepare general reports expressing the views of the Council on the principles which ought to be applied for the development of the national economy and the realisation and maintenance of full employment at adequate wages with reasonable price stability and reasonable long term equilibrium in the balance of external payments. The Council shall have regard to the level and trend of incomes, with a view to the inclusion in its reports of policy recommendations on these matters".

43. The first major task entrusted to the N.I.E.C. was to examine in detail the second expansion programme other than its agricultural aspects. As a first step the Council has carried out an examination of the validity of the assumptions underlying the industrial part of the programme and the feasibility of the growth targets. The Council has published an interim report in which it states that the overall industrial target is capable of being achieved and that the detailed targets for broad industrial sectors provide a realistic starting point for discussions with industries. The Council intends to follow up this report with comments on other aspects of the programme.

44. It is not clear what role the N.I.E.C. will play in implementing the programme, particularly since agriculture is not represented on it. Indeed it is probably early to determine what general procedures will need to be evolved to ensure the application and follow-up of the programme. Experience of other countries suggests, however, that two conditions must be fulfilled if the programme is to serve any useful purpose beyond the benefits that flow from its preparation. First, if the programme is not to be overtaken by events, it must be revised as events develop and prospects change. Second, arrangements are required within each government department to ensure that policy in individual sectors conforms with the programme. The system of periodic progress reports set up with the first programme could usefully be continued. And the annual budget debate in Parliament provides an obvious occasion to assess the application of the programme, and to revise it where necessary.

IV. CONCLUSIONS

45. The main conclusions of this survey can be summarised as follows:

a) The First Programme for Economic Expansion (1959-1963) was highly successful. It raised the annual growth rate substantially to more than 4 per cent. It reduced rates of unemployment as well as emigration. And it contri-

buted importantly to the creation of more dynamic attitudes on the part of both labour and management—a development reflected in sharp increases of both business investment and exports.

b) The expansion slowed down in 1962, largely because of a weakening of foreign demand. But a faster rate of growth was resumed in 1963, and prospects point to an increase in 1964 [the first year of the Second Programme for Economic Expansion (1964-70)] of between 4-5 per cent assuming normal weather conditions.

c) The second programme envisages an increase in real GNP of more than 4 per cent a year, with a further decline in unemployment and emigration. This will require some further increase in the investment rate, possibly greater than the one at present estimated. With public consumption also rising rapidly, the increase in private consumption will have to be kept below the rise in GNP.

d) The programme envisages a small deficit on the current account of the balance of payments and import of foreign capital to accelerate the development of the economy. This would seem to be an appropriate objective, given the need for higher investment, and the fact that agricultural protection abroad is hampering Ireland's most important export. But if it should appear that imports are increasing faster than expected a faster growth of exports will also be called for if the current account deficit is to be kept within manageable limits.

e) The implementation of the programme will require further rapid structural change, with a continued outflow of labour from agriculture and strong industrial expansion. Government policy has an important role to play in facilitating this process, and in dealing with the social problems resulting from rapid structural adjustment.

f) Grants for adaptation and re-equipment combined with a continuing policy of reducing protection from foreign competition are contributing to raising efficiency in Irish industry.

g) Maintenance of economic stability is an important condition for achieving the objectives of the second programme; this may require a more active and flexible budget policy, and an incomes policy is likely to prove a necessity.

h) The Government must ensure that the implementation of the programme is not hampered by inadequate administrative arrangements. In particular, it is important that the programme should be revised as needed to take account of changes in prospects, and that suitable procedures are adopted so that administrative decisions, at all levels of government, are taken in the light of the programme's requirements.

STATISTICAL ANNEX

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Table I. EXPENDITURE ON GROSS NATIONAL PRODUCT

	1955	1956	1957	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963
a) £ Million at current prices									
1. Consumers' expenditure	421.1	422.4	431.1	456.9	465.5	495.5	526.9	566	604
2. Public authorities' current expenditure	64.5	68.5	67.5	70.5	73.9	78.1	82.3	91	96
3. Gross fixed capital formation	91.5	90.5	79.3	79.6	81.8	88.0	104.4	119	135
of which: private	77.2	76.2	67.7	67.9	69.2	75.1	88.5	101	...
public	14.3	14.3	11.6	11.7	12.6	12.9	15.9	18	...
4. Increase in stocks and work in progress	+9.7	—7.9	—6.6	—7.7	+23.0	+10.4	+3.0	+11	+7
5. Exports of goods and services[1]	186.2	183.2	205.3	209.1	217.2	241.8	279.3	281	306
6. Total use of resources	773.0	756.7	776.6	808.4	861.4	913.8	995.9	1068	1148
7. *Less:* Imports of goods and services[1]	232.5	208.7	208.0	221.9	238.0	255.4	291.4	307	339
8. Gross national product at market prices	540.5	548.0	568.6	586.5	623.4	658.4	704.5	761	809
b) £ Million at constant (1958) prices									
1. Consumers' expenditure	468.1	456.7	446.5	456.9	464.9	490.7	511.1	529	551
2. Public authorities' current expenditure	72.5	73.8	70.4	70.5	73.2	75.6	76.3	81	84
3. Gross fixed capital formation	102.6	95.8	80.4	79.6	82.6	87.2	100.5	111	125
of which: private	86.4	80.6	68.6	67.9	69.8	74.4	85.3	91	...
public	16.2	15.2	11.8	11.7	12.8	12.8	15.2	20	...
4. Increase in stocks and work in progress	+10.0	—8.9	—7.5	—7.7	+23.7	+10.4	+2.7	+11	+7
5. Exports of goods and services[1]	194.2	193.7	212.7	209.1	211.8	239.0	276.1	271	289
6. Total use of resources	847.4	811.1	802.5	808.4	856.2	902.9	966.7	1003	1056
7. *Less:* Imports of goods and services[1]	242.3	212.8	201.4	221.9	242.7	256.1	288.9	303	328
8. Gross national product at market prices	605.1	598.3	601.1	586.5	613.5	646.8	677.8	700	728

1. Including income payments to and from rest of world.

Source: Irish submission to O.E.C.D.

TABLE II. PRODUCTION, EMPLOYMENT AND OTHER ECONOMIC INDICATORS

	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1962 1st Qtr.	1962 2nd Qtr.	1962 3rd Qtr.	1962 4th Qtr.	1963 1st Qtr.	1963 2nd Qtr.	1963 3rd Qtr.	1963 4th Qtr.
1. Volume of agricultural output[1] *(1953 = 100)*	103.9	108.7	110.6	110.8									
2. Cattle numbers *(thousands)* (mid year count)	4684	4741	4713	4742	4860								
3. Index of industrial production, transportable goods *(1953=100)*	117.5	126.0	137.5	144.5	154.1	136.3	150.4	139.3	151.4	142.4	156.3	154.1	163.4
of which:													
4. — mining and quarrying	181.0	159.2	189.1	185.1	197.5	126.5	345.7	160.6	107.7	113.4	306.3	256.2	113.9
5. — manufacturing	114.5	124.3	135.0	142.5	151.9	136.3	142.2	138.6	152.8	143.2	149.9	149.6	165.0
6. Employment in transportable goods industries[2] *(thousands)*	153.1	160.0	167.3	170.7	176.4	168.1	169.9	171.6	173.0	172.2	174.5	178.2	180.8
7. No. of males engaged in farm work *(thousands, 1st June)*	389.1	382.8	380.2	360.8	354.9								
8. Unemployment (registered) *(thousands)*	60.5	52.7	46.8	46.5	50.2	56.7	45.6	36.1	47.7	64.6	49.9	37.4	48.9
9. Unemployment as percentage of insured labour force *(per cent)*	8.0	6.7	5.7	5.7	6.1	6.7	5.8	5.0	5.4	7.5	6.2	5.0	5.5
10. Net outward passenger movement by sea and air[3] *(thousands)*	—39	—43	—27	—21	—22	—34.0	+22.3	—34.8	+25.8	—26.9	+22.7[5]	—35.8[5]	+18.1[5]
11. Average hours worked per week in transportable goods industries (number)[4]	45.4	45.0	44.6	44.5	44.6	43.8	43.9	44.5	44.7	43.6	44.3	44.6	44.8
12. Value of average weekly retail sales *(1961 = 100)*			100	107	113	96	106	107	118	101	113	115	125
13. New private cars, registered for first time *(thousands)*	22.9	27.9	28.6	31.9	36.9[5]	8.6	9.8	7,3	6.1	9.3[5]	10.9[5]	9.3[5]	7.3

1. Net output, adjusted for stock changes, excluding turf.
2. Quarterly figures are for March, June, September and December. Annual figures are averages.
3. « + » indicates a net inward movement.
4. Annual figures are for September; quarterly figures relate to March, June, September and December.
5. Provisional.

Source: Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin, and O.E.C.D. General Statistics.

Table III. PRICES AND WAGES

	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1962				1963			
						1st Qtr.	2nd Qtr.	3rd Qtr.	4th Qtr.	1st Qtr.	2nd Qtr.	3rd Qtr.	4th Qtr.
1. Consumer prices[1] *(mid-August 1953= 100)*	116.5	117.0	120.2	125.3	128.4	123.3	126.5	125.9	125.6	127.7	127.4	127.3	131.2
2. *of which,* food prices[1] *(mid-August 1953 = 100)*	118.1	116.5	120.6	123.2	125.0	122.5	126.1	123.1	121.1	126.1	124.6	123.2	126.1
3. Wholesale prices *(1953 = 100)*	113.5	112.9	114.7	118.3		117.1	119.0	118.9	118.4	119.2	119.8	119.8	
4. Agricultural prices *(1953 = 100)*	102.4	99.6	100.0	101.7	101.9	103.5	102.3	100.0	100.7	101.6	101.8	100.7	103.0
5. Store cattle prices (1-2 year olds) (Average monthly prices at fairs, £ per head)	41.1	34.8	36.3	39.3	38.9	39.9	39.6	39.1	38.4	38.6	39.8	38.8	38.1
6. Industrial prices *(1953 = 100)*	112.8	114.4	116.4	120.8		118.9	120.8	121.5	121.8	121.9	122.1	122.5	
of which:													
— simply transformed	105.4	105.9	106.1	107.1		105.9	107.0	107.6	107.8	107.5	107.0	107.1	
— more elaborately transformed	115.5	117.4	120.2	125.8		123.6	125.8	126.7	127.0	127.3	127.7	128.2	
7. Average hourly earnings in transportable good industries[2] *(October 1953 = 100)*	128.4	137.3	145.3	164.4	169.8	158.1	163.3	164.4	167.3	165.4	168.8	169.8	
8. Hourly wage rates in agriculture *(1953 = 100)*	126.1	131.0	134.7	150.3	150.3	142.0	142.0	150.3	150.3	150.3	150.3	150.3	150.3

1. Quarterly figures for February, May, August and November.
2. Annual figures for September, others for March, June, September and December.

Source: Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin.

Table IV. MONEY AND BANKING

	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1962				1963			
						1st Qtr.	2nd Qtr.	3rd Qtr.	4th Qtr.	1st Qtr.	2nd Qtr.	3rd Qtr.	4th Qtr.
1. Currency circulation[1] *(£ thousand)* (average of Saturdays)	79,868	79,132	84,040	90,117	94,123	90,117	89,040	90,709	95,482	94,123	95,571	98,915	103,946
2. Discount rate of Central Bank[2] *(per cent)*	$4^{1}/_{4}$	$4^{5}/_{8}$	$5^{9}/_{16}$	$3^{55}/_{64}$	$3^{63}/_{64}$	$4^{45}/_{64}$	$4^{3}/_{32}$	$3^{15}/_{16}$	$3^{55}/_{64}$	$4^{1}/_{32}$	$3^{61}/_{64}$	$3^{15}/_{16}$	$3^{63}/_{64}$
3. Price of 3.50 per cent Exchequer Bonds[3] *(per £100 stock)*	86.6	85.1	82.6	84.1	88.6	82.0	83.8	85.5	86.4	87.8	88.8	89.9	89.9
4. Price index number of ordinary stocks and shares *(1953=100)*	125.5	157.9	187.0	214.2	261.3	205.7	215.2	210.1	225.7	244.0	258.2	258.8	284.1
Commercial Banks:[2]													
5. Current accounts *(£ million)*	129.3	138.6	147.9	160.9	180.5	134.5	147.7	147.8	160.9	150.1	168.2	168.4	180.5
6. Deposit accounts *(£ million)*	201.9	210.7	226.2	242.4	242.3	233.2	235.7	238.8	242.4	245.5	243.8	246.2	242.3
7. Bills *(£ million)*	6.4	6.7	13.8	13.0	16.5	10.7	20.8	20.8	13.0	14.1	20.4	21.3	16.5
8. Loans and advances *(£ million)*	171.9	189.7	199.2	218.7	238.1	202.8	206.5	210.7	218.7	223.4	231.5	234.6	238.1
9. Net external assets *(£ million)*	103.5	103.6	111.4	115.1	101.9	111.9	113.9	111.9	115.1	112.7	102.9	107.0	101.9
10. Ratio of external assets to deposits *(per cent)*	31.2	29.7	29.8	28.5	24.1	30.5	29.7	28.9	28.5	28.5	25.0	25.8	24.1

1. Annual figures for March, others for March, June, September and December.
2. End of period.
3. Annual figures are monthly averages, quarterly figures are for March, June, September and December.

Source: Quarterly Statistical Bulletin of the Central Bank of Ireland, Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin.

Table V. FOREIGN TRADE AND PAYMENTS

	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1962				1963			
						1st Qtr.	2nd Qtr.	3rd Qtr.	4th Qtr.	1st Qtr.	2nd Qtr.	3rd Qtr.	4th Qtr.
1. Imports *(£ million)* (monthly average)	17.7	18.9	21.8	22.8	25.5	22.4	22.4	21.6	24.8	23.1	26.7	23.3	28.8
2. Exports *(£ million)* (monthly average)	10.9	12.7	15.0	14.5	16.4	14.3	12.9	15.2	15.7	14.4	15.9	17.7	17.1
3. Trade balance *(£ million)* (monthly average)	—6.8	—6.1	—6.7	—8.3	—9.1	—8.1	—9.6	—6.3	—9.2	—8.8	—10.8	—5.6	—11.7
4. Volume of imports *(1953 = 100)*	109.6	114.4	130.9	137.2	150.2	135.6	134.1	130.0	149.0	136.8	157.6	136.7	169.6
5. Volume of exports *(1953 = 100)*	109.6	130.2	155.6	149.1	164.2	148.1	131.5	155.5	161.3	145.9	160.3	177.6	172.9
6. Import prices[1] *(1953 = 100)*	104.7	106.6	107.7	107.6	110.0	109.6	110.9	110.3	110.1	111.2	112.0	113.0	112.5
7. Export prices[1] *(1953 = 100)*	104.0	102.2	101.0	101.9	104.0	102.5	103.8	103.7	103.4	104.2	105.9	106.0	106.3
8. Terms of trade[1] *(1953 = 100)*	99.4	95.9	93.8	94.7	95.0	93.6	93.6	94.0	93.9	93.7	94.6	93.8	94.5
9. Total external assets *(£ million)* (end of period)	210.2	209.9	224.5	234.0	236.9	227.0	225.2	227.6	234.0	234.1	223.6	232.7	236.9
of which:													
— Central Bank	86.8	89.2	95.9	104.3	119.4	95.3	93.4	97.7	104.3	101.3	105.1	110.1	119.4
— Associated banks (net)	103.5	103.6	111.4	115.1	101.9	111.9	113.9	111.9	115.1	112.7	102.9	107.0	101.9
— Departmental funds	19.9	17.1	17.2	14.6	15.6	19.8	17.9	18.0	14.6	20.1	15.6	15.6	15.6

1. Quarterly figures are for February, May, August and November.

Source: Irish Trade Journal and Statistical Bulletin, Quarterly Statistical Bulletin of the Central Bank of Ireland.

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